

TABLETOP SKIRMISH GAME

STRIKE TEAM

BASIC RULES

TWO TEAMS. THREE COMMAND POINTS. ONE SURVIVOR.

WHAT IS STRIKE TEAM?

Strike Team is a fast-paced tactical skirmish game for two players. Each player commands a squad of five elite operants — soldiers, scouts, specialists — in a close-quarters battle fought across ruined urban terrain, industrial complexes, and hostile wilderness. Games last 30–60 minutes and require no board: only a play surface, terrain, miniatures, and dice.

Unlike large-scale wargames, **Strike Team** focuses on the individual. Every operant has a name, a role, and a unique special ability. Every decision matters. Losing a single operative can swing the battle. There are no respawns, no reinforcements, and no extraction plan — only the mission.

The game blends the tactical depth of a miniatures wargame with the character-driven mechanics of a d20 styled tabletop roleplaying game. Operant stats are presented as character sheets: Movement, Hit Points, Armor Class, Perception. Combat is resolved with a d20 roll, keeping the system intuitive for players from both hobby traditions.

THE WORLD

NEAR-FUTURE. NO LAW. ONLY CONTRACT.

It is the mid-22nd century. Nation-states have fractured. The gap between the last war and the next one is measured in weeks, not years. Private military corporations now fill the void left by collapsed governments — enforcing contracts, seizing resources, and eliminating threats with surgical precision.

Most conflicts never make the news. They are settled quietly, in the dark, by small teams of expendable professionals. These operants are the instrument of choice: five soldiers, deployed behind enemy lines with no support, no witnesses, and a clear objective.

THE FACTIONS

● CRIMSON TALONS VANGUARD

A veteran rapid-response unit built from the ruins of a dissolved special operations programme. The Talons operate under a strict chain of command, led by their battle-hardened Sergeant. They are disciplined, adaptable, and fiercely loyal to one another. Where other units rely on firepower, the Talons rely on coordination — their greatest weapon is the team itself. They fight not for money, but for the belief that someone has to hold the line.

● ASHBORN SYNDICATE STRIKE CELL

The Syndicate is a corporate mercenary outfit operating on the edge of legality — and frequently beyond it. Their operants are augmented with black-market cybernetics: optical implants, combat reflexes, reinforced skeletal frames. They take contracts others refuse and ask no questions about the target. The Syndicate doesn't lose operants — it replaces them. Loyalty is a line item on the budget. What holds this cell together isn't brotherhood. It's the payout.

In *Strike Team*, these two factions are in direct opposition — but the rules support any narrative you build. Rename the teams, create new operants, and make the world your own.

WHAT DO YOU NEED TO PLAY



DICE

You will need a set of polyhedral dice. Both players share or bring their own. The following dice are used in Strike Team:

d4	d6	d8	d10	d20
Poison, Burning damage & light weapon damage	Sidearms, blades & general weapon damage	Rifles, axes & heavy weapon damage	Marksman rifles, cannons & sniper weapons	All attack rolls and Perception (Scout) checks

Tip: Having 2–3 of each die speeds up play, especially for blast weapons that roll multiple dice at once.



RULER OR MEASURING TAPE

All distances in Strike Team are measured in **inches**. You need a ruler or flexible measuring tape marked in inches to measure movement, weapon ranges, and ability radii.



10 MINIATURES (FIVE RED, FIVE BLUE)

Each team requires five miniatures on **1-inch round bases**. Use two sets in contrasting team colours:

- **5 Red miniatures** — Crimson Talons Vanguard (Operants #1–5)
- **5 Blue miniatures** — Ashborn Syndicate Strike Cell (Operants #1–5)

Each miniature must be individually identifiable by its **operant number (#1–#5)**, matching the number printed on that operant's character sheet. Use numbered bases, stickers, paint markings, or small numbered tokens beneath each model.



TOKENS & MARKERS

You will need the following tokens during play. Small coloured coins, poker chips, or printed chits all work well:

TOKEN	QTY	PURPOSE
Spotted	10	Placed next to an operant detected by a Scout action — marks them as targetable by Shoot actions. Removed when that operant moves at least 1".
Overwatch	2	Placed when Phantom (Crimson Talons) uses their Overwatch Eye ability — triggers a free attack
Demolition Charge	1	Placed on terrain by Ironkeg — explodes when triggered or detonated remotely
Sentry Drone	1	Placed on the battlefield by Arc (Ashborn Syndicate) — attacks independently each round



PLAY MAT OR PLAYING SURFACE

Strike Team is played on a flat surface representing the battlefield. The recommended playing area is **30" × 24"** — large enough to give operants room to maneuver while keeping engagements tense. Any of the following work well:

- **Neoprene game mat** — printed with urban, industrial, or wilderness textures (ideal)
- **Plain green or grey felt** — cheap and easy to cut to size
- **Poster board or large cutting mat** — practical for casual play
- **Tabletop with marked grid** — use a 1" grid mat for easier distance measuring



TERRAIN OBSTACLES

Terrain pieces create the obstacles, cover, and chokepoints that make the game tactical. You need a mix of **blocking terrain** (fully hides operants) and **cover terrain** (partial protection). Recommended pieces:

TERRAIN PIECE	TYPE	SUGGESTED QTY
Ruined walls / barricades	Cover	6–8
Shipping containers / crates	Cover & Blocking	4–6
Small buildings / ruins	Blocking	2–4
Rock formations / boulders	Cover	4–6
Trees / dense foliage clusters	Obscuring	3–5
Fuel drums / pillars	Cover	4–6

Miniature terrain, 3D-printed scenery, LEGO bricks, or cardboard cut-outs all work. What matters is that both players agree on which pieces **block line of sight** and which only grant **cover (+2 AC)** before the game starts.

SETTING UP THE PLAY AREA

BOARD SIZE · TERRAIN PLACEMENT · DEPLOYMENT ZONES

A well-constructed play area rewards tactical movement, punishes reckless charges, and ensures neither team has a natural advantage. Follow these steps before the first turn.

STEP 1 — LAY OUT THE BOARD

Set up your playing surface (**30" × 24"** recommended). Orient it so the long edges face each player. Define the two short edges as **deployment edges** — each player deploys from their own edge.

Deployment zone: Each player places all five of their operants within **4" of their deployment edge** before the game begins. Operants start visible — Spotted tokens are not required at deployment.

STEP 2 – PLACE TERRAIN

Players alternate placing terrain pieces, one at a time, starting with the player who lost the last dice roll (or a coin flip for the first game). Follow these guidelines for a balanced battlefield:

- Aim for **8–14 terrain pieces** total on a 30"×24" board.
- Place **at least 2 large blocking pieces** (buildings, container stacks) in the central zone to create mid-field cover and break long sightlines.
- Scatter **cover pieces** (crates, barricades, boulders) across the board – roughly one piece every 6–8".
- Place **trees or foliage** in clusters of 2–3 to create obscuring zones where operants can hide.
- No terrain piece may be placed within **3" of a deployment edge**.
- No terrain piece may be placed within **1" of another terrain piece**.

STEP 3 – AGREE ON TERRAIN RULES

Before the game, both players must agree on the following for each terrain type:

TERRAIN TYPE	BLOCKS LINE OF SIGHT?	GRANTS COVER (+2 AC)?	PASSABLE?
Solid walls / buildings	 Yes	 Yes (edge)	 No
Crates / barricades	 Yes (if taller than base)	 Yes	 No
Boulders / rocks	 Yes	 Yes	 No
Trees / foliage	 Yes (obscuring)	 Yes	 Yes (costs +1" per 2" moved through)
Fuel drums / pillars	 No	 Yes	 No

STEP 4 – DEPLOY OPERANTS

Players roll off (d20, highest wins) to decide who deploys first. The **winner deploys last** – a tactical advantage. Players alternate placing one operant at a time within their deployment zone until all ten operants are on the board.

Tip: Place scouts (Phantom, Whisper) near flanks for early Overwatch positions. Deploy heavy operants (Ironkeg, Vault) centrally where they can control chokepoints. Keep your medic (Stitch) behind other operants at deployment.

OVERVIEW

Two players each control a **Strike Team** of five operants. Players alternate turns, spending **Command Points** to activate operants — maneuvering for position, gathering intelligence, and eliminating the enemy.

The goal is to **down all enemy operants**, or achieve your mission objective before the enemy achieves theirs.

TURN STRUCTURE

3 COMMAND POINTS PER TURN

Players alternate taking turns. On **your turn**, you receive **3 Command Points (CP)**. Each CP is spent on one action assigned to one operant.

Key rule: An operant may receive up to 3 CP per turn — one Move, one Scout, and one Shoot/Fight — but **the same action type cannot be assigned twice to the same operant**. Unused CP are lost at end of turn.

 MOVE 1 CP Move one operant up to their full MOV distance in any direction. Operants in cover at end of move gain +2 AC vs ranged until they move again.	 SCOUT 1 CP Attempt to detect a hidden enemy. Roll d20 + PER vs Detection DC (set by distance). On success, the target is Spotted and can be targeted.	 SHOOT / FIGHT 1 CP Attack a visible (Spotted) enemy. Roll d20 + ATK bonus vs target's AC. On a hit, roll weapon Damage Dice and apply any Special effects.
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Examples: Move one operant, Scout with them, then Shoot with them (all 3 CP on one operant). Or Move one operant and Shoot with two others. You cannot Shoot twice with the same operant, but you can Shoot with two different operants.



MOVE

Choose one operant. Move them up to their full **MOV** distance (in inches) in any direction.

- Operants **may not move through** other operants or impassable terrain.
- Moving within **1" of an enemy** ends your movement — you are now engaged in melee.
- An operant ending their Move in **cover** (wall, crate, barricade) gains **+2 AC** against ranged attacks until they next move.



SCOUT

Choose one operant. They attempt to detect a **hidden enemy**. An enemy starts hidden if they are behind a structure with no line of sight from any of your operants — hidden operants **cannot be targeted** by Shoot or Fight actions.

HOW TO SCOUT

1. Declare which enemy operant you are scouting for and their approximate location.
2. Roll **d20 + your operant's PER modifier**.
3. Compare the result to the **Detection DC** for that distance.

DISTANCE TO TARGET	DETECTION DC
0" – 8"	10
9" – 16"	13
17" – 24"	16
25" – 32"	19
33"+	22

- **Success:** Place a **Spotted token** next to the target's miniature. That operant can now be targeted by Shoot and Fight actions. The Spotted condition is removed as soon as the target moves at least **1"**.
- **Failure:** The CP is wasted. You may try again next turn.
- **Line of Sight required:** Your operant must have a clear line to at least part of the structure the target hides behind. You cannot Scout through solid walls.

SHOOT / FIGHT

Choose one operant. They attack a **visible (Spotted)** enemy — one that is not hidden, or that has already been Spotted.

RANGED ATTACK (SHOOT)

1. Choose a ranged weapon and a target within that weapon's **Range**.
2. Roll **d20 + weapon's Attack Bonus**.
3. If the result equals or exceeds the target's **AC**, the attack **hits**.
4. Roll the weapon's **Damage Dice** and subtract from the target's HP.
5. Apply any weapon **Special** effects on a hit.

Cover: If the target is in cover, their AC increases by **+2** against this attack.

Out of Range: You may not Shoot against a target beyond your weapon's listed range.

MELEE ATTACK (FIGHT)

1. Your operant must be **within 1"** of the target (engaged in melee).
2. Choose your melee weapon.
3. Roll **d20 + weapon's Attack Bonus**.
4. If the result equals or exceeds the target's **AC**, the attack **hits**.
5. Roll the weapon's **Damage Dice** and subtract from the target's HP.
6. Apply any weapon **Special** effects on a hit.

Cover does not apply to melee attacks — it only protects against ranged fire.

DAMAGE & DOWNED OPERANTS

- When an operant's **HP reaches 0**, they are **Downed** — remove them from the battlefield immediately.
- Downed operants may not take actions, be activated, or block movement.
- There is **no recovery** from being Downed unless a Special Ability explicitly states otherwise.

THE SPOTTED CONDITION

THE ONLY CONDITION IN STRIKE TEAM

An enemy operant that is **hiding behind an obstacle** — out of direct line of sight — cannot be targeted by Shoot or Fight actions until they are **Spotted**.

When a Scout action succeeds, the scouting operant has detected the hidden enemy. Place a **Spotted token** next to that enemy's miniature to identify their condition. That operant can now be targeted for shooting — as long as the attacker has line of sight to any part of the target's position.

Removing Spotted: The Spotted condition is removed immediately when the target operant moves at least **1"**. They are once again hidden and cannot be targeted until Spotted again by a new Scout action.

SITUATION	CAN BE TARGETED?
In open — no obstacle between attacker and target	✔ Yes
Behind obstacle, no Spotted token	✖ No — must Scout first
Behind obstacle, has Spotted token	✔ Yes — until they move 1"
Had Spotted token, moved 1" or more	✖ No — token removed, must Scout again

QUICK REFERENCE — YOUR TURN

TURN SETUP	MOVE (1 CP)	SHOOT / FIGHT (1 CP)
› Receive 3 Command Points (CP) › Each CP = one action on one operant › Max: 1 Move + 1 Scout + 1 Shoot per operant › Unused CP are lost	› Move up to MOV distance › Cover → +2 AC vs ranged SCOUT (1 CP) › d20 + PER vs Detection DC › Success → target Spotted	› Target must be Spotted › d20 + ATK vs target AC › Hit → roll damage dice › Miss → no effect › Cover: +2 AC (ranged only)

EXAMPLE TURN

IRONCLAD VS VAULT · 3 COMMAND POINTS

IRONCLAD (CRIMSON TALONS) TAKES HER TURN

- CP 1 — Move:

Ironclad moves 5" forward and ducks behind a crate. She is now in cover (+2 AC vs ranged).
- CP 2 — Scout:

She suspects Vault is lurking 14" away. Rolls d20 + 4 PER = **17** vs DC **13**. Success — Vault is **Spotted**.
- CP 3 — Shoot:

Ironclad fires her Combat Rifle (+5 ATK, 1d8+2). Rolls d20 + 5 = **19** vs Vault's AC **18**. A hit! Rolls 1d8+2 = **7 damage**. Vault drops from 24 HP to **17 HP**.
- Turn passes to the Ashborn Syndicate player.